Humana Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Same-Claim Billing Standards

Application: Medicare Advantage and Medicaid Products **Published date:** 06/2026

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Related policies: N/A

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Overview

This policy outlines Humana's requirements and prohibitions for same-claim billing. Each statement outlined in this policy applies to both the reporting of reimbursable claims and the reporting of encounters, which are non-reimbursable claims for which the information is gathered for reporting.

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In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Same-Claim Billing Requirements and Prohibitions When Applicable Regulatory Standards Exist

When applicable regulatory standards exist establishing which services must be on the same claim and which services are not permitted to be on the same claim, Humana requires providers to comply with those standards.

Same-Claim Billing Requirements and Prohibitions When Applicable Regulatory Standards Do Not Exist

Same-Claim Billing Requirements

In the absence of applicable regulatory standards, Humana generally requires providers to submit all charges for the same *encounter* on one claim.

Additionally, Humana generally requires a provider that submits a professional claim to report all charges for same-day services on that claim, regardless of whether they pertain to the same *encounter*.

Exceptions:

- When reference laboratory billing is acceptable, Humana permits a reference laboratory reporting charges for testing performed in distinct, specific service facility locations to submit a distinct claim for each service facility location. Note that this exception does not permit a reference laboratory to submit multiple claims for testing, that would otherwise be subject to a general requirement above, for the same service facility location.
- Humana permits Tax Equity and Fiscal Responsibility Act (TEFRA) hospital interim claim billing, consistent with Original Medicare's guidance on interim claim billing.

Same-Claim Billing Prohibitions

Apart from same-day professional-claim services, Humana generally does not permit a provider to report charges for services furnished in multiple *encounters* on the same claim.

However, Humana also permits providers to report charges, on the same outpatient hospital claim, for *repetitive services* furnished in multiple *encounters* during the same calendar month.

Treatment of Submissions that Violate Same-Claim Billing Requirements and Prohibitions

At Humana's sole discretion, Humana rejects, denies or recoups reimbursement for submissions that violate same-claim billing requirements and same-claim billing prohibitions, as outlined in this policy.

Timely Filing Alert

Humana has established standards for determining whether reported charges meet applicable timely filing requirements, and those standards apply to all charges, including to charges reported on the same claim for services furnished in multiple *encounters*. For example, on a claim with charges for hospital outpatient *repetitive services* furnished during a month, Humana will deny a charge that was not submitted timely even if another *repetitive services* charge on that claim is timely and, therefore, potentially reimbursable.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Encounter:***
  - For the purposes of professional claim billing discussed herein, an encounter is the entirety of one direct interaction, including a direct interaction using audio or audio and video technology, between the patient and the rendering provider, including any and all staff; or, in the absence of direct interaction between the patient and the rendering provider, the entirety of the interaction between the patient and the practitioner, including any and all staff, who ordered the services

furnished by the billing provider or who referred the patient to the billing provider. For the purposes of professional claim billing discussed herein, multiple individuals are considered one rendering provider when, due in part, for example, to common specialty, it is appropriate to bill for services furnished as though they were one rendering practitioner.
  - For the purposes of institutional claim billing discussed herein, an encounter is the entirety of one direct interaction between the patient and the billing provider, including any and all staff, from the first moment that relevant interaction began. Note that, for these purposes, services subject to requirements such as a three-day payment window billing requirement or a readmission same-claim billing requirement are treated as being within the meaning of "the entirety of one direct interaction."
  - With respect to both professional claim billing and institutional claim billing discussed herein, the phrase "any and all staff" includes, in addition to those types of persons typically referred to as staff, each person or entity engaged in the provision of services for the patient, on the provider's behalf, under any sort of agreement or arrangement with the provider.
- ***Repetitive services:*** Services referred to as "defined as repetitive services" in Section 50.2.2 of Chapter 1 of the Medicare Claims Processing Manual.

References

- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 1 – General Billing Requirements. Sections 50.2.1 and 50.2.2. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 4 – Part B Hospital (Including Inpatient Hospital Part B and OPPS). Section 170 – Hospital and CMHC Reporting Requirements for Services Performed on the Same Day. www.cms.gov.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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